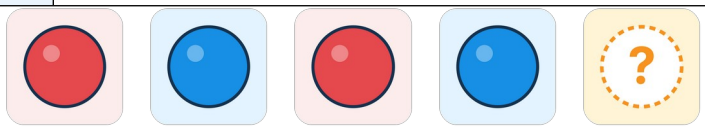
02 · Lesson spec

What is a Pattern? · 40 minutes · whole class, then pairs · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can copy and continue a pattern.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	pattern · repeat · same · next · colour
Materials	Red and blue paper sheets (one per child for the line); colour cards; large card counters in red and blue (counted out per pair); pattern strips (Printables); optional large card shapes with pre-punched holes and thick string



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Show** Ayo's lights card. **Say:** "Ayo's lights flash: red, blue, red, blue… What comes next?" (red)
- **Say:** "When something goes again and again, it is a **pattern**. A pattern **repeats**." Link back: "Remember **Do It Again** in Term 1? Patterns do it again too!"
- **Ask:** "Where in our classroom do you see something that goes again and again?" (tiles, stripes, a song, the fence)
- **Hand signs:** pattern = tap left, tap right, tap left, tap right · repeat = draw a circle · same = point to two matching things · next = point forward.

2. Do in pairs (25 min)

a) Pattern line, whole class (8 min) · Core: Move

- Give each child red or blue paper. Build a line: red, blue, red, blue. **Say:** "Who can join next?" The next child must hold the right colour.
- Say the pattern aloud together as you point: "red, blue, red, blue…" Saying it helps children hear the repeat.

b) Copy and continue, pairs (12 min) · Core: Code

- **Count the counters out** to each pair (e.g. 8: 4 red, 4 blue).
- Pairs **copy** a pattern strip with the counters, then **continue** it 2 more. The class checks by saying it aloud.
- Optional Build: thread large card shapes on thick string in a red–blue pattern (holes punched by an adult).
- **Stretch:** continue an ABB pattern (red, blue, blue, red, blue, blue…).
- **Count the counters back in** before Share.

c) Activity Book page (5 min)

- Colour what comes next; circle the pattern. Not marked.

3. Share (10 min)

- Two pairs show their pattern; the class says it aloud and checks it.
- **Create** (if time allows): colour Ayo's lights in a red–blue pattern.
- **Close:** "Smart thinkers notice repetition. This term we are pattern detectives!"

Common mistakes

- Copying only the first two colours, then stopping → say the whole pattern aloud and point along it.
- Putting two of the same colour together (red, red) → “Say it: red, blue… what did we say after red?”

What if it doesn’t work?

- Counters are hard to share → use children holding paper (the pattern line) instead.
- No coloured paper → use clapping and stamping (clap, stamp, clap, stamp) as the pattern.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** continue just 1 more counter, then 2.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): continue an ABB pattern.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **copies and continues an AB pattern**.

> **Safety**
> No bottle caps or small pieces in child hands. Count counters in and out. Counters and threading shapes bigger than a toilet-roll tube opening; adults punch any holes.